



## Razer Project Linda

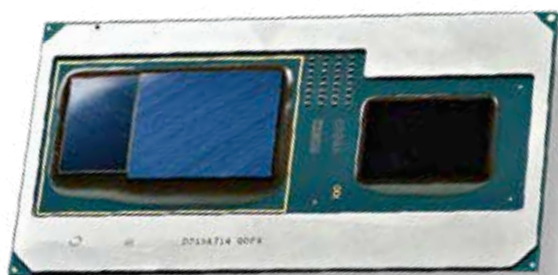
*A smartphone-dock that is also a laptop*

Over the years, we've seen quite a lot of fancy phone docks at the Digit Test labs and elsewhere. But the Project Linda concept from Razer beats all of them hands down. That's because the dock is a 13.3-inch laptop that uses the Razer phone to power itself! Placing the phone in a slot, where the trackpad would usually be gives you a trackpad, but also a secondary touchscreen display that you can use to tweak specific settings and controls. There is also a strong focus on the user being able to play Android games seamlessly because it has a Razer Chroma backlit keyboard and additional mouse support. If you're wondering how long your Razer phone will last while powering a laptop, don't worry, because there's also a built-in powerbank that will charge your phone while it is docked! Let's just hope this sees the light of the day. <http://digit.in/RazrLinda>

## Intel+AMD for Intel 8th Gen CPUs

*CPUs with power of dedicated GPUs*

A few months ago, Intel and AMD made a surprising announcement to say they'd be working together. At CES 2018 we got to see the result of this collaboration. The new 8th Gen i5 and i7 chips are powered by discrete AMD Radeon RX Vega M GPUs. These chips are going to be part of Intel's H-series lineup, which means that these chips will show up on some of the most high-end gaming laptops that will be releasing soon, capable of feats like 4K gaming and professional content creation. The chips will also allow overclocking on the CPU, the GPU and HBM, and will be available in two power configurations of 65W and 100W. As can be seen from the benchmarks posted by Intel, overall performance is almost 3 times better than a 3-year old system. Why a three-year old system? Marketing decision probably. <http://digit.in/IntelRad>



## VR is here to stay, sans wires

*HTC Vive Pro and Vive Wireless Adaptor, Oculus Go and Mi VR, Lenovo Mirage*

The debate about the future of VR has been on for a while. This year, CES brought quite a few VR products that gave us a glimpse of its very real, and wireless, future. For starters, HTC has taken into account all the shortcomings of the original Vive and worked to improve them on the Vive Pro. The upcoming standalone VR headset features displays with 78% higher resolution that puts it ahead of its competitors. Additionally, inbuilt headphones with an adjustable strap aim to make it more comfortable while dual cameras and dual microphones aim to offer developers more hardware to take advantage of. But the most significant thing



about the Vive Pro could very well be the compatible Vive Wireless adapter that, although not the first of its kind, uses Intel's Wi-Gig technology. Wi-Gig operates in the 60 GHz band, thus preventing any interference and providing low latency performance.

On the other end of the spectrum, Oculus Go promises some good, portable VR experiences as well. Announced during Qualcomm's CES 2018 press conference by Facebook VP of VR Hugo Barra, the standalone headset will be powered by the Snapdragon 821. It was also announced that Xiaomi will be manufacturing the device, with a near identical China specific variant being dubbed the Mi VR standalone. While this is also effectively wireless VR, expecting this to offer anything more than what today's smartphone-based VR headsets do would be a mistake.

Talking about standalone mobile VR, Lenovo's Mirage is the first standalone Daydream-based VR headset. It comes with a Qualcomm Snapdragon 835 processor, 4GB of RAM and 64GB of storage, along with higher degrees of freedom and a wider field of view than the Oculus Go, making this a better choice – for now.

If you're already confused about which to buy, you know that 2018 is going to be amazing for VR.